

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Marxism and Neo-Marxism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Marxism and Neo-Marxism

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1 Marxism, Scientific Socialism and Core Vocabulary | 2 The Classical Marxist Argument and Essential Distinctions |
| 3 Thinkers, Illustrations and the Three-Strand Matrix | 4 Ownership Boundaries and UPSC Trap Repair |
| 5 Historical Materialism Without Mechanical Determinism | 6 Class, State, Exploitation and Alienation |
| 7 Gramsci and the Frankfurt School | 8 Althusser, Dependency Theory and Classification Cautions |
| 9 Objections, Qualified Thesis, Evidence and Doctrine Architecture | 10 Indian Application, Mark-Scaled Answers and Proposition Discipline |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Marxism and Neo-Marxism - Solved Practice Workbook	3
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	3
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	14
ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	18

Marxism and Neo-Marxism - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g3 **PYQ ownership:** Every verified question below retains the primary owner recorded in the source ledger.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Classical Marxism**?

A. the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation. B. base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. C. Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism. D. Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Classical Marxism** with **the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.**

A. Human problem B. Classical Marxism C. Base-superstructure - non-mechanical D. Historical materialism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.** with **Classical Marxism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Dialectical materialism**?

A. forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations. B. Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects. C. the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development. D. Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Dialectical materialism** with **the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.**

A. Key names B. "Critically examine"/"Critically analyse" C. Surplus value D. Dialectical materialism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.** with **Dialectical materialism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Historical materialism**?

A. the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life. B. classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination. C. Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique. D. Marx, Engels, Lenin, Luxemburg, Mao.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Historical materialism** with **the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.**

A. Historical materialism restated as a mechanism B. Historical materialism C. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) D. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.** with **Historical materialism.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Surplus value**?

A. Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure. B. argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires. C. the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest. D. economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gauba, PDF p.48).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Surplus value** with **the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.**

A. Mode of production B. Classical Marxism C. Base vs superstructure D. Surplus value

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.** with **Surplus value.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism**?

A. the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society. B. founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production. C. represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production. D. forces of production (means of production plus labour power/technique) combine with relations of production (ownership patterns and class relations) to form the economic base (Gauba, PDF pp.48-49).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism** with **the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society**.

A. Fetter/rupture mechanism B. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism C. Dialectical materialism D. Forces of production vs relations of production

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society**. with **Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Base vs superstructure**?

A. Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism. B. Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism. C. base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. D. when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gauba, PDF p.49).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Base vs superstructure** with **base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture**.

A. Base-superstructure - non-mechanical B. Historical materialism C. Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism D. Base vs superstructure

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture**. with **Base vs superstructure**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Forces of production vs relations of production**?

A. forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations. B. Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects. C. Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production. D. the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gauba's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gauba, PDF pp.48, 53).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Forces of production vs relations of production** with **forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.**

A. "Critically examine"/"Critically analyse" B. Forces of production vs relations of production C. Surplus value D. Base determines superstructure mechanically

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.** with **Forces of production vs relations of production.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism**?

A. Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique. B. Marx, Engels, Lenin, Luxemburg, Mao. C. classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination. D. Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (§15, Chains 1-2).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism** with **classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination.**

A. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) B. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism C. Marx and Engels D. Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination.** with **Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Base determines superstructure mechanically**?

A. Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure. B. argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires. C. economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gauba, PDF p.48). D. Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§20).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Base determines superstructure mechanically** with **Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure..** The

other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.**

A. Classical Marxism B. Base determines superstructure mechanically C. Base vs superstructure D. Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.** with **Base determines superstructure mechanically.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Marx and Engels**?

A. represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production. B. forces of production (means of production plus labour power/technique) combine with relations of production (ownership patterns and class relations) to form the economic base (Gauba, PDF pp.48-49). C. founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production. D. the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marx and Engels** with **founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.**

A. Dialectical materialism B. Forces of production vs relations of production C. Young Marx D. Marx and Engels

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.** with **Marx and Engels.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong**?

A. Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism. B. Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism. C. when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gauba, PDF p.49). D. the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong** with **Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism.**

A. Historical materialism B. Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong C. Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism D. Frankfurt School

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism.** with **Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Young Marx**?

A. Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production. B. the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gauba's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gauba, PDF pp.48, 53). C. Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects. D. the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Young Marx** with **Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.**

A. Surplus value B. Base determines superstructure mechanically C. Herbert Marcuse D. Young Marx

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.** with **Young Marx.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Frankfurt School**?

A. Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique. B. Marx, Engels, Lenin, Luxemburg, Mao. C. Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (§15, Chains 1-2). D. the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Frankfurt School** with **Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique.**

A. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism B. Frankfurt School C. Marx and Engels D. Louis Althusser

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique.** with **Frankfurt School.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Herbert Marcuse**?

A. economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gauba, PDF p.48). B. Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§20). C. argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires. D. the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Herbert Marcuse** with **argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires.**

A. Base vs superstructure B. Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong C. Core focus D. Herbert Marcuse

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires.** with **Herbert Marcuse**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Louis Althusser**?

A. represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production. B. forces of production (means of production plus labour power/technique) combine with relations of production (ownership patterns and class relations) to form the economic base (Gauba, PDF pp.48-49). C. the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation. D. base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Louis Althusser** with **represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production.**

A. Forces of production vs relations of production B. Louis Althusser C. Young Marx D. Human problem

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production.** with **Louis Althusser**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Core focus**?

A. when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gauba, PDF p.49). B. the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development. C. Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism. D. forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class

relations.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Core focus** with **Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism.**

A. Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism B. Frankfurt School C. Key names D. Core focus

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism.** with **Core focus**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Human problem**?

A. Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production. B. the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gauba's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gauba, PDF pp.48, 53). C. the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life. D. classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Human problem** with **Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production.**

A. Base determines superstructure mechanically B. Human problem C. Herbert Marcuse D. Historical materialism restated as a mechanism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production.** with **Human problem**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Key names**?

A. Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (§15, Chains 1-2). B. the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest. C. Marx, Engels, Lenin, Luxemburg, Mao. D. Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Key names** with **Marx, Engels, Lenin, Luxemburg, Mao..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Marx, Engels, Lenin, Luxemburg, Mao.**

A. Marx and Engels B. Louis Althusser C. Mode of production D. Key names

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marx, Engels, Lenin, Luxemburg, Mao.** with **Key names**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Historical materialism restated as a mechanism**?

A. economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaub, PDF p.48). B. Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§20). C. the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society. D. founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Historical materialism restated as a mechanism** with **economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaub, PDF p.48)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaub, PDF p.48)**.

A. Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong B. Historical materialism restated as a mechanism C. Core focus D. Fetter/rupture mechanism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaub, PDF p.48)** with **Historical materialism restated as a mechanism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Mode of production**?

A. the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation. B. base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. C. forces of production (means of production plus labour power/technique) combine with relations of production (ownership patterns and class relations) to form the economic base (Gaub, PDF pp.48-49). D. Gaub lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mode of production** with **forces of production (means of production plus labour power/technique) combine with relations of production (ownership patterns and class relations) to form the economic base (Gaub, PDF pp.48-49)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **forces of production (means of production plus labour power/technique) combine with relations of production (ownership patterns and class relations) to form the economic base (Gaub, PDF pp.48-49)**.

A. Young Marx B. Human problem C. Base-superstructure - non-mechanical D. Mode of production

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **forces of production (means of production plus labour power/technique) combine with relations of production (ownership patterns and class relations) to form the**

economic base (Gauba, PDF pp.48-49). with **Mode of production**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Fetter/rupture mechanism**?

A. when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gauba, PDF p.49). B. the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development. C. forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations. D. Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Fetter/rupture mechanism** with **when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gauba, PDF p.49)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gauba, PDF p.49)**.

A. Frankfurt School B. Fetter/rupture mechanism C. Key names D. "Critically examine"/"Critically analyse"

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gauba, PDF p.49)** with **Fetter/rupture mechanism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Base-superstructure - non-mechanical**?

A. the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life. B. classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination. C. the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gauba's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gauba, PDF pp.48, 53). D. Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Base-superstructure - non-mechanical** with **the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gauba's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gauba, PDF pp.48,**

53).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gauba's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gauba, PDF pp.48, 53).**

A. Herbert Marcuse B. Historical materialism restated as a mechanism C. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) D. Base-superstructure - non-mechanical

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gauba's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gauba, PDF pp.48, 53).** with **Base-superstructure - non-mechanical**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **"Critically examine"/"Critically analyse"**?

A. Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (§15, Chains 1-2). B. the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest. C. Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure. D. argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **"Critically examine"/"Critically analyse"** with **Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (§15, Chains 1-2).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (§15, Chains 1-2).**

A. Louis Althusser B. "Critically examine"/"Critically analyse" C. Mode of production D. Classical Marxism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (§15, Chains 1-2).** with **"Critically examine"/"Critically analyse"**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)**?

A. the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society. B. founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production. C. Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§20). D. represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)** with **Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§20).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§20).**

A. Core focus B. Fetter/rupture mechanism C. Dialectical materialism D. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§20).** with **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional Paper II questions. Their primary owner remains the Philosophy Political Ideologies corpus; they are reproduced here only where the Political Theory topic supplies the directly tested doctrine.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q3(b), 15 marks

Question: Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically.

Model solution

Thesis. Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent **ONLY CONDITIONALLY**: they are consistent where collective ownership genuinely **ENLARGES** each person's real self-development and democratic control, and they become inconsistent -- the emancipatory claim defeating itself -- where "collective" power hardens into bureaucratic command.

- **Reframe "freedom".** Marx rejects a purely negative liberty (non-interference)

that leaves formal rights operating over radically unequal social conditions. His positive ideal is non-domination **PLUS** self-development: the capacity to engage in conscious, social, creative activity, of which alienated labour deprives the worker (evidence P3 -- estrangement from product, activity, species-being and others).

- **The consistency argument.** If the means of production are brought under genuinely social, democratic control, then the structural coercion of the wage-relation is removed and freedom is **EXTENDED** to those the market subordinated -- collective ownership is the condition, not the enemy, of real freedom.

- **The self-defeat condition (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objection (bureaucratic domination): state ownership can become ownership by officials, and a transitional "dictatorship of the proletariat" can entrench rather than wither (the strongest historical objection at §2.9). Reply (M. N. Roy's radical humanism): retain Marx's critique of exploitation but reject economic determinism and party absolutism and restore individual reason and ethical autonomy, since concentrated power cannot reliably serve emancipation. Residual: the historical record of transitional states remains adverse, so accountability, plural organisation and civil liberty must be built **INTO** the transition, not postponed.

Verdict (conditional). Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent as an **IDEAL** of collective self-development, and inconsistent in any form that subordinates the individual to class, party or historical necessity; the doctrine survives only if it constitutionalises the freedom it promises.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it turns "consistent?" into the "only if... otherwise self-defeats" conditional (P3 + §2.8), brings M. N. Roy as the internal Indian reply, concedes the adverse record, and grades rather than answers yes/no.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2019 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: What do you consider to be the future of Marxism in the context of the prevalent free-market economy?

Model solution

Thesis. In a prevailing free-market economy the **FUTURE** of Marxism lies in its survival as a diagnostic and critical framework, not as an infallible prediction of collapse or a blueprint for a command economy: what persists is the

analysis; what fails is the timetable and the party-state remedy.

- **What the free market vindicates in Marx.** Concentration of capital, commodification, precarity, recurrent crises and the ideological normalisation of market relations remain live phenomena the analysis still explains (evidence P2 -- the contradiction between developing forces and existing relations; P4 -- structural exploitation through surplus value, argued as a relation, not via the contested price theory).

- **What the free market falsifies.** Revolution did not first triumph in the most advanced economies; welfare compromise, universal franchise and political organisation altered the trajectory. Marxism is an explanatory framework, not an infallible schedule -- and the neo-Marxist turn already absorbed this: causal weight was RELOCATED into ideology and the state (P6 Gramsci's hegemony; P8 Poulantzas's relatively autonomous state) rather than the doctrine abandoned.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: the collapse of command economies refutes Marxism. Reply: it refutes the unaccountable party-state, not the critique of exploitation; the two must be separated. Residual: Marxism supplies no internal safeguard against the transitional state entrenching itself -- that gap is why its political future depends on democratic and constitutional reconstruction.

Verdict (relocation). The future of Marxism under free markets is as a REFINED critical tradition: its diagnosis of concentration, precarity and ideological reproduction retains force; its predictive schedule and command-economy remedy do not; so it will endure as analysis and critique rather than as a governing programme -- with no verdict passed here on any particular country.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it splits diagnosis (P2/P4, still explains) from prediction and remedy (falsified), uses the neo-Marxist relocation (P6/P8) as the survival mechanism, and grades without commenting on any actual regime.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2020 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: How far is Marxism as a philosophical doctrine relevant in the present context? Justify your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. Marxism as a PHILOSOPHICAL doctrine remains substantially relevant -- as a method, a critique and a theory of ideology -- even where its 19th-century predictions and 20th-century political implementations have failed; relevance must be judged by diagnostic power, not by the fate of any regime.

- **The philosophical core that survives.** Historical materialism reads social formations through productive forces, relations of production and class (evidence P2); the theory of alienation diagnoses the estrangement of labour under commodified production (P3); the critique of ideology explains how contingent, class-bound relations come to appear natural and inevitable (and Gramsci's hegemony, P6, and Althusser's interpellation, P7, extend this into culture and subject-formation). These are analytical instruments, not dated slogans.

- **Where it needs correction.** Economic reductionism is a real tendency: caste, religion, gender and nationalism have relative autonomy and cannot be derived from class alone -- so class analysis is NECESSARY BUT INSUFFICIENT, especially in India (§2.9). The reply treats these as materially embedded powers rather than mere epiphenomena, expanding the analysis through hegemony and social reproduction.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: authoritarian outcomes discredit the doctrine. Reply: separate the critique of exploitation from the unaccountable transitional state; the philosophy is not the regime. Residual: the doctrine offers no internal safeguard against that state -- the strongest standing objection.

Verdict (diagnosis/remedy split). The philosophical analysis of concentration, exploitation and ideological reproduction retains force; the institutional remedy -- an unaccountable transitional state -- does not, and the theory supplies no internal guard against it. Marxism is therefore relevant as critique and method, refined rather than refuted.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it isolates the philosophical core (P2/P3/P6/P7), concedes the necessary-not-sufficient limit and the authoritarian residual, and closes on the diagnosis/remedy split rather than a yes/no on "relevance".

Solved PYQ 10 - 2023 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Explain Historical Materialism and discuss its relevance in the context of social development and change.

Model solution

Thesis. Historical materialism explains social formations through the interaction of productive forces, relations of production, class structure and political-ideological institutions; it remains highly relevant to social development and change AS A METHOD, provided its base-superstructure relation is read non-mechanically and supplemented where class alone is insufficient.

- **The doctrine as a causal chain (evidence P2).** (1) Human beings must produce the means of life; (2) production occurs through definite social relations; (3) productive forces develop within those relations; (4) existing relations eventually become FETTERS on further development; (5) the conflict between forces and relations becomes social and political struggle; (6) a new mode of production can emerge through that struggle. The elements: productive forces (capacity), relations of production (ownership/control), mode of production (their unity), base/superstructure (a relation, NOT a one-way switch) and class struggle (the motor of transformation).
- **Relevance to social development and change.** It supplies a materialist account of WHY social orders change -- technological and productive development destabilising inherited property relations -- and of how law, politics and ideology are anchored in social labour and power. Extended by Gramsci's hegemony (P6) and Althusser's reproduction (P7), it explains not only revolution but the STABILITY of orders through consent and subject-formation.
- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: economic determinism -- caste, religion, gender and nationalism cannot be read off the base. Reply: historical materialism can treat these as materially embedded powers with relative autonomy, not epiphenomena. Residual: in India especially, class analysis is NECESSARY BUT INSUFFICIENT -- caste operates through status, endogamy and social reproduction that class alone cannot derive; say this before the objection is put.

Verdict (necessary-not-sufficient). As a research programme, historical materialism remains a powerful explanation of social development and change; its limit is reductionism, repaired by reading the base-superstructure relation reciprocally and adding the independent mechanisms of caste, gender and culture -- so it is refined, not refuted.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it runs P2 as six numbered premises (not slogans), states the base/superstructure caution pre-emptively, extends via P6/P7, and grades with the necessary-not-sufficient verdict tuned to Indian social change.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as propounded by Marx.

Model solution

Thesis. For Marx, ALIENATION is the estrangement of the worker from their own productive life under conditions of private property and the division of labour -- a structural condition of capitalist production, broader than low pay, in which labour that should be self-realising becomes an external, compelled and dispossessed activity.

- **The four dimensions (evidence P3, from the 1844 Manuscripts).** The worker is estranged (1) FROM THE PRODUCT, which confronts them as another's property; (2) FROM THE ACTIVITY of labour, which is externally compelled rather than self-realising; (3) FROM SPECIES-BEING, as conscious creative activity is reduced to a means of survival; and (4) FROM OTHER PERSONS, as workers compete and social relations assume commodity form.
- **The mark-bearing distinction.** Alienation is BROADER THAN LOW WAGES: a well-paid

worker can remain alienated where labour, product and purpose are controlled by others. So the remedy is not merely higher pay but restored control over the activity and ends of work -- which is why alienation, not just inequality, is central to Marx's critique.

- **Objection -> reply.** Objection: species-being assumes a controversial universal human essence. Reply: it can be reconstructed MINIMALLY -- persons require meaningful agency, social recognition and control over their central activities -- without positing a fixed metaphysical essence.

Verdict. Alienation names a genuine and enduring feature of commodified, hierarchically controlled work; its diagnostic reach extends well beyond the 19th-century factory to contemporary labour wherever activity, product and purpose are severed from the producer -- which is why it remains Marx's most portable concept.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- as an EXPOSITION it leads with the definition and the four dimensions (P3), makes the "broader than low wages" distinction the centrepiece, adds only one controlled objection/reply, and keeps exposition dominant as the directive demands.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology.

Model solution

Thesis. Evaluated as a political ideology, Marxism is exceptionally strong as a METHOD, a CRITIQUE and a theory of IDEOLOGY, and correspondingly weak as a PREDICTION and as an institutional programme; its enduring value is diagnostic, its recurring failure political -- and a fair evaluation must keep the two apart.

- **What Marxism is.** Simultaneously a method (dialectical-historical analysis), a critique (exploitation, alienation, commodity relations, ideology), a theory of change (contradiction and class struggle) and a political project (collective emancipation). As ideology in the DESCRIPTIVE sense it guides action; in the PEJORATIVE sense it is itself the theory that UNMASKS ideology as the naturalising of class-bound relations.

- **Strengths (evidence).** Historical materialism explains structural change (P2); surplus value shows exploitation as a RELATION, not unfair bargaining, so it survives even where the labour theory of value is contested (P4); the critique of ideology, extended by Gramsci's hegemony (P6) and Althusser's interpellation (P7), explains how orders secure consent.

- **Objections, each with reply and residual (§2.9).** (1) Economic determinism -> treat caste/gender/culture as materially embedded, relatively autonomous powers -> residual: class is necessary but insufficient, sharply so in India. (2) Failed prediction (revolution not in advanced economies) -> Lenin's weakest-link and vanguard revision (P5) -> residual: the vanguard has no mechanism subordinating party to class (substitutionism). (3) Authoritarian outcome -> build liberty and accountability into the transition -> residual: the historical record stays adverse and the theory offers no internal safeguard. (4) Class reductionism -> anti-caste and feminist analyses identify distinct mechanisms.

- **The neo-Marxist relocation.** Later Marxism keeps the materialist mechanism but relocates causal weight into party, culture and state form (P8 -- the relatively autonomous state) -- refinement, not abandonment.

Verdict (diagnosis/remedy split). Marxism's analysis of concentration, exploitation and ideological reproduction retains force; its institutional remedy -- an unaccountable transitional state -- does not, and it supplies no internal guard against that outcome. As an ideology it is therefore best judged a powerful CRITIQUE in permanent search of a safe political form.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it evaluates on BOTH senses of ideology, banks the strengths (P2/P4/P6/P7), runs all four §2.9 objections to residuals with the P5 revision, adds the P8 relocation, and closes on the diagnosis/remedy split, not a verdict on any regime.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain the relation between forces and relations of production in historical materialism. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Historical materialism explains social formations through the interaction of productive capacity and the social relations governing production.

Core analysis: Forces of production include labour, skills, tools and technology. Relations of production organise ownership, control and the position of classes. Together they constitute a mode of production. As productive forces develop, inherited relations may become fetters that obstruct further development. The resulting contradiction is expressed through class struggle and may culminate in institutional rupture and a new social formation. The mechanism links material production to law, politics and ideology without reducing history to isolated ideas.

Critical evaluation: The relation is not an automatic sequence. Political organisation, culture and contingent struggle influence whether contradiction produces reform, repression or revolution.

Conclusion: Historical change occurs when developing productive forces are constrained by existing relations of ownership and control, but the transition is mediated through social and political struggle rather than mechanical necessity.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Present Marx's concept of alienation and distinguish it from economic inequality. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Alienation describes the worker's estrangement within capitalist production and is broader than unequal income or wealth.

Core analysis: The worker is alienated from the product, which confronts its producer as another's property; from the labour process, which is externally controlled; from species-being, because creative activity is reduced to a means of survival; and from other persons, whose relations are mediated by competition and exchange. Inequality concerns distribution, whereas alienation concerns control, purpose and self-realisation within the productive relation. A redistribution of income can therefore reduce inequality while leaving alienated labour intact.

Critical evaluation: The concept depends on a contested account of human flourishing, but it remains powerful when reconstructed around agency, recognition and meaningful control over work.

Conclusion: Alienation concerns loss of control, self-realisation and human relation within production; redistribution may reduce inequality without removing that deeper form of estrangement.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine the base-superstructure relation in classical and neo-Marxist thought. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The base-superstructure model relates the mode of production to legal, political and cultural institutions.

Core analysis: Classical Marxism gives the economic structure decisive explanatory weight because ownership and production organise class power. Yet the relation should not be read as a one-way switch. Neo-Marxists develop its reciprocal character: Gramsci shows how civil society and hegemony organise consent; the Frankfurt School examines culture and manipulated needs; Althusser analyses ideological and repressive apparatuses that reproduce

social relations. The superstructure therefore stabilises or contests the base rather than merely reflecting it.

Further development: Gramsci and Althusser illustrate two different corrections. Gramsci emphasises political agency, organic intellectuals and contest within civil society; Althusser emphasises structural reproduction through ideological and repressive apparatuses. The Frankfurt School adds culture and administered consciousness. These developments answer the objection that economics alone explains history, but they also make the theory harder to falsify because domination can be located across many mutually supporting institutions.

Critical evaluation: If economic determination is made wholly mechanical, historical agency disappears. If culture becomes completely autonomous, the distinctively Marxist account of material power is lost.

Conclusion: The relation is best read as structured interaction: the economic base sets powerful limits, while law, politics and culture also reproduce or transform the social order.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Discuss Gramsci's concept of hegemony as a development within Marxism. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Gramsci develops Marxism by explaining why class rule persists through consent as well as direct coercion.

Core analysis: Hegemony is the capacity of a leading class to present its interests as a common social outlook through institutions of civil society, including education, religion, media and associations. Political society supplies law and coercion, while civil society secures active or passive consent. Organic intellectuals organise rival experience into a counter-hegemonic worldview. In advanced societies, transformation therefore requires a prolonged war of position within civil society rather than reliance only on a frontal seizure of state power.

Further development: The distinction between war of manoeuvre and war of position follows from this analysis. A direct assault may be possible where civil society is weak, but dense associations in advanced societies require a long struggle over common sense and institutional leadership. This expands revolutionary strategy beyond the factory and the state. It also allows subordinate groups to build consent before taking governmental power, though it raises the question of whether counter-hegemony can avoid becoming another form of ideological closure.

Critical evaluation: Gramsci gives culture and agency greater causal weight without abandoning class analysis. The risk is stretching hegemony so widely that every form of agreement appears manipulated.

Conclusion: Gramsci extends Marxism by showing that durable rule depends on organised consent in civil society as well as coercion, thereby making culture a terrain of political struggle.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate Marxism as a theory of capitalism, domination and social transformation. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Marxism combines a method of social analysis, a critique of capitalism, a theory of historical change and a political project.

Core analysis: Its analysis links private control of production to surplus appropriation, class conflict and the structural dependence of labour. Historical materialism explains how productive forces and relations generate contradictions, while alienation identifies the human cost of externally controlled work. The state and dominant ideas help stabilise class relations. Neo-Marxism deepens the account through hegemony, culture, ideology and dependency, showing that domination is not maintained by economics alone.

Further development: Its evidence architecture spans several levels: surplus value explains appropriation within production; alienation explains loss of agency; the state protects general conditions of class rule; ideology naturalises

contingent relations; and historical materialism links contradiction to transformation. Gramsci and the Frankfurt School explain why crisis need not automatically produce revolution, while dependency theory extends domination to colonial and neo-colonial relations. The strongest reply to Marxism is that democratic welfare reform, plural identities and state autonomy exceed a simple two-class model. Its strongest defence is that these modifications do not remove the structural power attached to ownership and accumulation. That residual insight sustains its contemporary relevance.

Critical evaluation: Marxism remains illuminating where accumulation and class power interact, but deterministic prediction, class reductionism and authoritarian outcomes weaken any claim to a complete philosophy of emancipation.

Conclusion: Marxism remains powerful where exploitation, accumulation and class power intersect, but its adequacy depends on resisting economic reductionism and authoritarian political closure.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Compare the humanist, structural and dependency-oriented strands of neo-Marxism. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Neo-Marxism revises classical Marxism by widening the mechanisms and scales through which domination is explained.

Core analysis: The humanist strand, associated with the Young Marx and critical theory, emphasises alienation, freedom, culture and manipulated consciousness. The structural strand, represented by Althusser, resists a philosophy centred on an essential human subject and analyses how economic, political and ideological structures reproduce a social formation. Dependency theorists shift the scale toward relations between developing societies and colonial or neo-colonial power. These strands therefore differ over agency, causal structure and the principal arena of conflict.

Further development: The strands also prescribe different emancipatory strategies. Humanism seeks recovery of agency and non-alienated life; structural analysis seeks transformation of the apparatuses reproducing class relations; dependency analysis seeks altered domestic and international relations of production. Gramsci occupies an important bridge because he combines material class leadership with cultural struggle. Habermas should not be merged with first-generation critical theory, and dependency theory should not be renamed world-systems theory without independent justification. Their plurality strengthens Marxism's reach but weakens any claim to one settled neo-Marxist method. Comparison must therefore retain both continuity and internal disagreement.

Critical evaluation: They should not be merged with world-systems theory or treated as abandoning Marxism. Each retains concern with material domination while correcting an overly mechanical base model.

Conclusion: These strands disagree over agency, structure and the scale of domination, yet each preserves Marxism by relocating causal weight beyond a mechanically conceived economic base.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.